CLAIMS

What is claimed is:

1. A system for covert data transfer, comprising:

    - a static electronic device comprising a data storage module, a wireless transceiver, and a power source;
    - wherein said electronic device is physically concealed within a hollow, non-visible interior space of an item of public infrastructure located in a publicly accessible area.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the item of public infrastructure is a retail store shelving unit.

3. The system of claim 1, wherein the wireless transceiver is a short-range transceiver, such as a Near-Field Communication (NFC) or Bluetooth Low Energy transceiver.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the electronic device is configured to receive and store data from a first user device at a first time, and to transmit the stored data to a second user device at a later second time.

5. The system of claim 4, wherein the electronic device is further configured to erase the stored data after it has been transmitted to the second user device.

6. A method for covertly transferring digital information, comprising the steps of:

    - Placing a static electronic storage device within a hollow structural component of an object in a public area, thereby concealing it from view;
    - A first operative, at a first time, approaching the object and wirelessly transmitting a data file to the concealed storage device; and

- A second operative, at a second, later time, approaching the object and wirelessly retrieving the data file from the concealed storage device.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein the object is a shelving unit in a retail store, and wherein the operatives appear as ordinary shoppers.

8. The method of claim 6, wherein the wireless transmission is performed using a short-range communication protocol, requiring the operative's device to be in close proximity to the object.